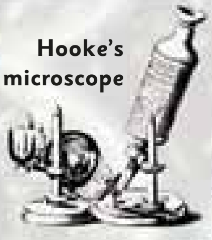
A closer look



Hooke's microscope

During the 17th century, the microscope was developed by Dutchman Anton van Leeuwenhoek and refined by Robert Hooke in England. Early models revealed the tiny organisms in water, while modern versions can look inside a single cell.

Inside view

When you go to hospital, the doctor may send you for a body scan. Using a powerful machine, the medical team can see what's going on inside you.

Hands on

Fill a cup or vase with water, and add a few drops of food colouring. Cut the end off the stem of a flower and put the flower in the water.

Plants take up food and water from the soil and transport it up the stem. Experiments allow scientists to observe and theorize how things work and why.

Types of scientist

Almost everything in the world is the subject of study by a scientific specialist.

Zoologists study animals of all kinds, except for human beings.

Biologists are interested in everything about life and living organisms.

Paleontologists know about fossils, and try to learn from them.

Botanists learn about the world of plants, plant types, and plant groups.

Chemists study elements and chemicals, and they help make new substances.

Astronomers are experts on space, the planets, the stars, and the Universe.

Entomologists are a special kind of zoologist who learn about insects.

Geologists find out about our Earth, particularly by studying rocks.

Archaeologists are interested in the remains of past peoples and lives.

Ecologists study the relationship between living things and their environment.

Oceanographers know all about ocean life and landscapes.

Some microscopes can magnify up to 1,000 times!